

ELECTRONIC COMMERCE RESEARCH

Q2 2026 JOURNAL REPORT

Current Journal Statistics

- **83 Articles Published Online for Q1-Q2 2026**
(2026 Online Article Budget: 136 Articles)
- **1,393 Submissions for Q1-Q2 2026**
(An increase from 895 Submissions in Q1-Q2 2025 and 668 Submissions in Q1-Q2 2024)
- **Average of 20 Days from Submission to First Decision for Q1-Q2 2026**
(A decrease from 25 days in Q1-Q2 2025 and 25 days in Q1-Q2 2024)
- **Average of 367 Days from Submission to Acceptance for Q1-Q2 2026**
(An increase from 316 days in Q1-Q2 2025 and 235 days in Q1-Q2 2024)
- **392,156 Article Downloads for Q1-Q2 2026**
(A decrease from 413,466 in Q1-Q2 2025, but an increase from 305,278 in Q1-Q2 2024)
- **2025 Impact Factor: 4.9**
(1,254 Citations from 256 Articles)
2024 Impact Factor: 4.7
(1,176 Citations from 251 Articles)

Updates from Springer

- **An update to our reference anomaly detection tool**

With the rise in use of large language models (LLMs) in scholarly publishing, the industry has seen an increase in hallucinated references. Such references do not exist in the literature and can result from inappropriate use of LLMs. Citing and referencing works that cannot be verified casts doubts on the quality of a paper and, if undetected, can undermine confidence in the scientific record.

We're continuing our focus on protecting the scientific record and ensuring reliable research practices and are happy to announce an additional feature to our reference anomaly detection tool. Submitted manuscripts will now be screened for non-existent DOIs.

A non-existent DOI is defined as a DOI that does not exist in the relevant databases that the tool searches.

If a submission is flagged, it will be withdrawn by our support teams. The specific reasons for the withdrawal will not be shared with the authors, to prevent bad actors from adapting to our detection capabilities. *For the same reason, information regarding this new feature is confidential.*

The addition of this feature will help further remove problematic papers before they progress into review, saving editors time and allowing for more focus on non-problematic submissions.

If you have any questions, please contact Clare Kernie at clare.kernie@springernature.com.



- **Springer Nature's open access agreements now support researchers in nearly three quarters of EU countries**

Springer Nature's open access (OA) agreements now cover nearly three quarters of EU countries (74% or 20 of the 27), enabling all researchers at affiliated universities to publish their work openly and benefit from greater reach and impact. In 2026, Springer Nature renewed agreements with national consortia in Czechia, Greece, Finland, reflecting the sustained demand for and value offered by these agreements.

Springer Nature is also continuing to further the wider European transition to OA, most recently with a four-year renewal with Swiss universities. This sits alongside a new national agreement in Iceland, and the renewal of its long-standing agreement in the UK.

Beyond Europe, 2026 has seen renewals and expansions in many markets across the globe, including Australia, New Zealand, South Africa, Japan and the US. Springer Nature now has over 85 Transformative Agreements globally, covering researchers from over 4,400 institutions. Since 2015, these agreements have enabled the publication of more than 300,000 OA articles, delivering real benefits for researchers, including greater visibility, increased impact, and wider social reach.

More on TAs and open access strategy and reach can be found in the latest [Annual Report](#).